YUJIN ZHANG

Contact Information

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
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Education

Columbia University in the City of New York, NY 2019-2026 (Expected)
Ph.D., Political Science
- Fields: International Relations (Major), Comparative Politics
- Dissertation: Early-Life Experiences and Global Public Opinions on Economic Policymaking
- Dissertation Committee: Allison Carnegie (Co-Chair), Nikhar Gaikwad (Co-Chair), Junyan Jiang, Calvin Thrall

M. Phil., Political Science 2022
M.A., Political Science 2020

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University, Washington, D.C. 2018
M.A., International Political Economy and International Economics

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO 2016
B.A., magna cum laude, Business Administration

Hunan University, Changsha, Hunan, China 2014
B.A., Finance

Research Interest

Research Focus: International political economy, backlash against economic and political liberalism, economic security and statecraft, political socialization
Regional Focus: East Asia, Developed Economies

Peer-Reviewed Articles

[1] 2024. "Political Trust and Government Performance in the Time of COVID-19." ***World Development*** 176 (106499), with Chengyuan Ji and Junyan Jiang.
– **Keywords:** Health governance, political trust

Paper Under Review

[4] "Assistance to Me, and to Thee: Early Inequality Experiences and Public Preferences for Overseas Aid."
– **Keywords:** Foreign Aids, Inequality, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, Developed Countries

[3] "Inflation of Populism: Effects of Early Economic Experiences on Support for Populist Parties."
– **Keywords:** Inflation, Populism, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, European Politics

[2] "Rethinking Backlash against Trade Openness: Import–Export Preferences in Two Dimensions" with Ziwen Zu.
– **Previous Title:** "Why Mercantilism?"
– **Keywords:** Globalization Backlash, Mercantilism, Isolationism, Survey Experiment, United States and China
– **Presentations:** APSA 2026, GSIPE-APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025

[1] "Prosperity and Openness: Early Globalization Experiences and Mass Preferences for Free Trade."

– **Keywords:** Formative experiences, trade preferences, East and Southeast Asia
– **Presentations:** APSA 2024, MPSA 2024

Working Paper

[3] "International Competition and Technological Preferences: Evidence from the United States and China." with Ziwen Zu.
– **Keywords:** Technological globalization, AI, geopolitical competition, U.S. & China, survey experiment
– **Presentations:** APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025

[2] "Partisan Responses to Economic Shocks: Inflation Crises and the Paradox of Trade Liberalization."
– **Keywords:** Inflation crisis, trade liberalization, political parties, electoral politics
– **Presentations:** APSA 2025, MPSA 2025

[1] "Aversion to What?: Early-Life Economic Experiences and Responses to Inflation."
– **Keywords:** Formative experiences, macroeconomic attitudes, Europe
– **Presentations:** APSA 2023

Research In Progress

[4] "Nationalist, United?"

[3] "On Industrial Policies."

[2] "Environmental and Electoral Consequences of the Trade War."

[1] "Life Experiences and Attitudes toward Military Alliance." with Allison Carnegie and Elizabeth Saunders.

Policy Publication

[1] 2018. "China's Coal-to-Gas Program: A Developing Environmental Governance Regime." *SAIS Review of International Affairs*.

Teaching Experience

Columbia University

Politics of International Economic Relations, Prof. Jeffry Frieden	Fall 2024
Chinese Politics, Prof. Junyan Jiang	Fall 2021, Spring 2023
China's Foreign Relations, Prof. Thomas Christensen	Spring 2021, Fall 2022, Spring 2025
International Politics, Prof. Alexander de la Paz	Spring 2022
Autocracy and Democracy, Prof. Timothy Frye	Fall 2020

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

Advanced Topics in International Trade (Graduate), Prof. Hiau Looi Kee	Spring 2018

Research Assistance

Columbia University

Prof. Nikhar Gaikwad	2022-25
Prof. Junyan Jiang	2021-23, 25

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

Prof. Ling Chen	2017-19
Prof. David Steinberg	2018-19

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

External

Expense Support Grant, Institute for Humane Studies ($7500)	2025
Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies ($3000)	2024
Finalist, NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars	2024
Travel Grant, Graduate Students in International Political Economy	2022

Travel Grant, International Studies Association 2019

Columbia University

C. Martin Wilbur Fellowship 2025-26
CPE Graduate Student Grant ($7000) 2025-26
Dissertation Fellowship 2023-24
Travel Grant 2023-26
Teaching Fellowship 2020-23, 24
Weatherhead East Asian Institute Fellowship 2019-20

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

SAIS Fellowship 2017-18

Colorado State University

Dean's List 2014-15
Global Partnership Fellow 2014-16

Conferences and Workshops

2026: APSA $^{c,d\times3,p\times2}$ ⋄ GSIPE-APSA Pre-Conference Workshop ⋄ ISA $^{c,p\times2}$
2025: IPES $^{p\times2}$ ⋄ GSIPE ^{d,p} ⋄ MPSA ^{d,p}
2024: Virtual International Political Economy Society ⋄ NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars ⋄ GSIPE Mini-Conference ⋄ GSIPE ^{d,p} ⋄ APSA ⋄ MPSA
2023: Northeast Regional Workshop in European Politics ⋄ GSIPE ^{d,p} ⋄ APSA
2022: GSIPE APSA Workshop
2021: Political Science Speaker Series
2019: ISA
2018: MPSA

$^{*}c = Chair, d = Discussant, p = Paper$

Skills

Languages: Mandarin (Native)
Programming: R, Stata, LaTeX, Python, LLM API integration
Methods: Survey design, experiment design, conjoint analysis

Service

Event Coordinator, Graduate Student in International Political Economy 2024-25

Referee

Social Science Research / *World Development*

Professional Experience

The US-China Business Council 2018-19
China Africa Research Initiative 2016-17, 2018-19
The Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars 2018
The Brookings Institution 2018

References

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